

60
Nd

Neodymium



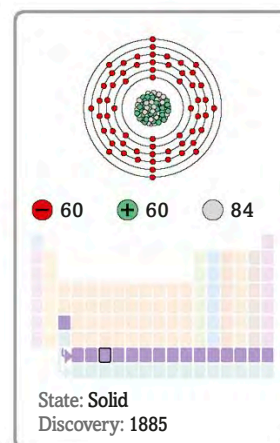
This glass gets its colour from very tiny amounts of neodymium.

Strong magnets made of neodymium can be used to lift thousands of times their own mass. This element was discovered in 1885 by the Austrian chemist Carl Auer von Welsbach, and it was originally used to colour glass. Small amounts of neodymium turn **glass** pinkish purple. Today, this element is also employed in lasers used in eye surgery.

Laboratory sample of pure neodymium



The pure element turns black when it reacts with air.

61
Pm

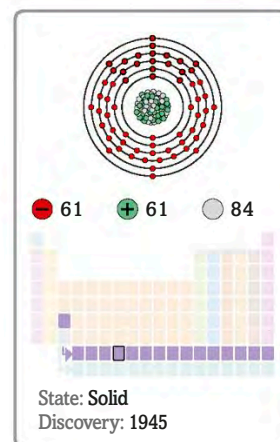
Promethium



Promethium-rich paint in a tin seen from above

This paint glows as a result of radioactive promethium.

This missile uses radioactive promethium for electrical power.



Missile

Promethium is the rarest lanthanide element. Any promethium that was in Earth's rocks decayed billions of years ago. Promethium is therefore produced artificially in nuclear reactors. Being very radioactive, it is used in some **missiles**, because it converts this radioactivity into electrical power. The addition of promethium also makes some **paints** glow in the dark.